St. Joseph's Anglo-Chinese School
F.6 English Language
Paper 2 Writing – Lesson 1 (Proofreading): Sentence completeness
Teacher's notes · 60 minutes · Lesson 1 of 3 before the mock · Both groups (Level 2 and Level 3)

TEACHER'S NOTES — keys, corrections and teaching notes in red. Not for students.

WHY THIS LESSON IS FIRST

The target is sentence completeness, because the marking criteria make it the first gate:

- Level 2 Language: "Simple sentences are well formed."
- Level 3 Language: "Simple sentences, and some complex sentences are well formed."
- Level 4 Language: "A range of sentence structures is used accurately and appropriately"; "errors do not affect overall clarity".

A sentence with no verb or no subject is not "nearly there" — a marker cannot read it. Note too that missing -s and article errors are not what caps this cohort: the 2025 Q1 Part A script scoring 16.5/21 (Level 5) contains "a integrated art club". Fix those, but the clarity-breakers come first.

PART 1: LESSON AT A GLANCE

Time	Stage	Teacher	Students
0–5	Pre-test	Say only: "One of the five sentences is already correct." No teaching yet.	Fix 5 sentences (2 min), then self-mark in a second colour (3 min).
5–15	One procedure	Board: "Is there a verb? Is there a subject?" Then the four ways a sentence dies, with one real example each from their own scripts. Nothing else — no rules, no terminology beyond the four labels.	Copy the two questions onto their error card.
15–25	Planted text	Time 10 minutes; announce 2 minutes left. Do not grade it — it is a gauge. Collect the totals.	Find the 8 errors in the text, number them, write the total.
25–40	Timed writing	Silent, pens only, no notes, no dictionaries. Start and hold the clock. At exam rate 15 minutes is about 75 words.	Write heading 1, "Our background", of the 2025 Q1 leaflet. Level 3 group: star one complex sentence.
40–45	Proofread own text	5 minutes today, 4 next lesson, 3 in the last — the real exam allowance. Call the last minute.	Apply the two questions to their own paragraph.
45–50	Fix	Enforce the ten-word rule. Move round the room; pick up the over-correctors.	Fix in a second colour, then peer-check: "is this correction actually right?"
50–58	Log and count	Take the class total onto the chart. Do not read out any individual's count.	Two numbers plus three rows on the error card.
58–60	Exit	One sentence each, round the room.	"The last error I found was …"

The four codes (used in every lesson of this sequence, so the counts compare):

Code	What it covers	Example from today
S	Sentence boundary: missing verb, missing subject, comma splice, fragment	"… every Friday, we meet …" → full stop + new sentence
V	Verb: ending, tense, missing "be"	the club invite → invited; the club very popular → is very popular
W	Word form: right word, wrong form	very exciting about → excited about
N	Noun and article	a art club → an art club

PART 2: PRE-TEST (5 MINUTES, SELF-MARKED)

One error in each sentence — except one sentence, which is already correct. Students fix them in pen, then self-mark from the board in a second colour. This is the class's first data point.

1. Our club was started by four art lovers in 2015, we now have more than 200 members.
2. A club member's most memorable experience a street painting challenge in Tsim Sha Tsui.
3. Because we want to share art with more teenagers.
4. Every month, the club hold a gallery for our members.
5. If you are interested in joining us, please email 852artclub@art.hk.

No.	The error	Corrected sentence	Code
1	Comma splice — two sentences joined by a comma	Our club was started by four art lovers in 2015. We now have more than 200 members.	S
2	No verb	A club member's most memorable experience was a street painting challenge in Tsim Sha Tsui.	S
3	Fragment — the sentence starts with "Because" and never reaches a main clause	Because we want to share art with more teenagers, we will open free weekend workshops this year. (Any sensible main clause is acceptable.)	S
4	Missing verb ending / agreement	Every month, the club holds a gallery for our members.	V
5	None — already correct	No change. If a student changed this sentence, they were guessing, not reading.	—

Say this before they start: "One of these five is already correct. If you change it, you were not reading." It is the cheapest way to break the Level 2 habit of rewriting everything.

PART 3: PLANTED-ERROR TEXT (10 MINUTES, 8 ERRORS)

Photocopy or project. Students number the errors and total them out of 8. Do not grade the score.

We are a art club run by teenagers, we meet in the school art room every Friday. Founded in 2015 by four students who wanted to share their drawing skills with other young people in Hong Kong. Our members can join painting, photography and pottery workshops, and we also hold a gallery in the school hall every month, all members can show their work there. Last year the club invite a local artist to teach a weekend

masterclass. Some members were very exciting about the visit. Our club also organise a street painting challenge every spring. The club very popular among S1 and S2 students. In the future, we plan to hold a photo competition and open a small gallery in Sham Shui Po. If you want to join us, please email 852artclub@art.hk.

No.	As printed	Correction	Code
1	We are a art club	an art club	N
2	… every Friday. (the comma before "we meet")	Full stop, then "We meet …" as a new sentence	S
3	The sentence beginning "Founded in 2015 … Hong Kong." has no main clause	It was founded in 2015 by four students who wanted to share their drawing skills …	S
4	… every month, all members can show their work there.	Full stop, then "All members can show their work there."	S
5	Last year the club invite a local artist	invited	V
6	Some members were very exciting about the visit	excited	W
7	Our club also organise a street painting challenge	organises	V
8	The club very popular among S1 and S2 students	The club is very popular …	V

Composition: 3 × S, 3 × V, 1 × W, 1 × N. Lesson 2's text keeps 8 errors but reverses the mix to 3 S / 4 V, so the two counts are the same size and the target shifts.

PART 4: TIMED WRITING (15 MINUTES)

Use the task itself. This is 2025 Paper 2 Part A, verbatim:

You work at the 852 Teen Art Club in Hong Kong. The club has asked you to write an information leaflet promoting the club. Below is the first page of the leaflet. Write the second page of the leaflet using the three headings below. The first one has been provided for you.

Our background / A club member's most memorable experience / Our future activities

Write the section under heading 1, "Our background" (approx. 75 words).

15 minutes, silent, pens only. No notes, no dictionaries, no talking.

Level 3 group: also include ONE complex sentence and put a star beside it.

Both groups write the same task in all three lessons, one heading per lesson — that is what makes the three proofreading counts comparable, and by the mock they will have a whole leaflet page they drafted and corrected themselves.

PART 5: PROOFREAD THEIR OWN TEXT, FIX, LOG (15 MINUTES)

Proofread (5 min): the same two questions, applied to the paragraph they have just written. Time it out loud.

Fix (5 min): in a second colour. Rule — find and fix. They may change at most ten words and may not restructure a sentence. Then peer-check in pairs: "is this correction actually right?"

Log (5 min): two numbers on the error card, plus three rows. The class total goes on the chart; no individual's count is ever read aloud.

caught	___ / 8 (planted text)
my writing	___ coded errors in ___ words
rows	Date | My sentence (wrong) | Correct version | Code — three rows today

The five worst-scoring sentences from the pre-test become the retrieval drill that opens Lesson 2, and the class's caught/8 is the first point on the class chart.

PART 6: WHAT TO WATCH

- Do not correct their scripts yourself this lesson. You count what they found — that is the whole demonstration, and it is what tells them the skill is theirs.
- Cut the teaching, never the writing. The 15-minute writing block is the first thing to disappear if the explanation overruns, and without it there is nothing to proofread.
- The planted-text score is a gauge, not a mark. The moment it is graded, students rewrite the whole text instead of hunting.
- Over-correction is the signal to name out loud: “You changed three correct sentences. That loses marks — a marker cannot read a sentence you have broken.”
- Keep the planted text at 8 errors every lesson and the same length. A longer or harder text makes the counts incomparable and the progress invisible.
- The proofreading window shrinks each lesson: 5 minutes, then 4, then 3. Practising at 8 minutes trains a habit they cannot execute in the exam.
- Never display one student's count. Class totals only, or seat numbers.

PART 7: CARRY-OVER TO LESSON 2

Target: verb endings — tense consistency and missing -s (the “basic grammatical structures are accurate” line at Level 3).

Plant: same length, 8 errors, 3 S / 4 V — two S items recycled from today so the class meets them a second time.

Writing block: heading 2, “A club member's most memorable experience” — past narrative, which is exactly where tense errors show up.

Retrieval: the five worst-scoring pre-test sentences from today.